

Md Al Amin

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Education

- **University of Georgia**, Athens, GA **Aug 2023 – Present**
Ph.D. in Agricultural and Applied Economics
 - *Dissertation*: “Nutrition Assistance Programs, Food Security, and Diet Quality in the United States”
 - *Relevant Coursework*: Consumer Demand Theory; Causal Inference and Machine Learning for Economic Applications; Experimental and Behavioral Economics
- **Ohio University**, Athens, OH **Aug 2022 – Aug 2023**
M.A. in Applied Economics – *GPA: 3.92/4.00*
- **University of Barishal**, Barishal, Bangladesh **Jan 2015 – Dec 2018**
B.S.S. in Economics – *GPA: 3.81/4.00*

Research Interests

Public Health, Environmental Economics, Development Economics, Energy

Job Market Paper

WIC Redemptions, Household Food Security, and the Quality of Food Acquisitions

Abstract: We estimate the associations between participation in the Special Supplemental Program for Women, Infants, and Children (WIC), household diet quality, and food security using the National Household Food Acquisition and Purchase Survey (FoodAPS) and augmented inverse probability weighting (AIPW). Diet quality is measured using the Healthy Eating Index (HEI)-2010, while food security is measured using a binary food insecurity indicator. We find that redeeming WIC benefits is associated with significantly higher diet quality relative to WIC-eligible nonparticipants, with improvements concentrated in fruit, whole grains, dairy, protein foods, seafood, and plant proteins. In contrast, WIC participation is not associated with statistically significant improvements in household food security. These findings suggest that maximizing WIC benefit redemption, rather than simply increasing program enrollment, may generate greater nutritional benefits for participating households.

Publications

Journal Articles

1. Salah Uddin, Muhammad, Mohammad Ismayl Al Masud, Md Roknuzzaman, Mohammad Ahsan Habib, and Md Al Amin. “Does the informal economy undermine political stability? Empirical evidence from global perspectives.” *Economics of Governance* 27, no. 1 (2026): 32.
2. Salah Uddin, Muhammad, Rashed Jahangir, Mamunur Rashid, Muhammad Hassan Abbas, and Md Al Amin. “The Role of Fintech and the Shadow Economy in Advancing Sustainable Development Across G7 Countries: Evidence From MMQR Analysis.” *Sustainable Development* (2026).
3. Siddik, Md Abu Bakkar, Shah Jalal Ahmed, Md Zahid Hasan, Abdulla Al Masud, Md Yeasin Arafat, Md Jane Alam, Akher Ali, Muhammd Mustafiz, Md Al Amin, and Mahedi Hasan. “Relationship between body mass index, eating disorders, internet addiction, and social media addictions among adolescents in Bangladesh.” *Public Health Challenges* 4, no. 4 (2025): e70142.
4. Amin, Md Al, and Md Tanvir Ahmed. “Beachgoers’ Knowledge, Perceptions, and Willingness to Pay for Sustainable Waste Management in Kuakata Sea Beach, Bangladesh.” *Nature Environment & Pollution Technology* 23, no. 2 (2024).

5. Chamuah, Suchibrata, Kiran, Divyashree N, Md Al Amin, Nazmin Sultana, Narendra Nath Hansda, Harish B M and Kohima Noopur. "Protected vegetable crop production for long-term sustainable food security." *Journal of Scientific Research and Reports* (2024).
6. Rahat, K. M. R., Md Al Amin, and Md Tanvir Ahmed. "Comparing tourists' travel cost and consumer surplus to estimate the recreational values of Kuakata Sea Beach in Bangladesh." *J Tourism Hospit* 13, no. 1 (2024): 1-7.
7. Ahmed, Md Tanvir, and Md Al Amin. "Perilous Resurgence of Dengue Fever in Bangladesh: Gender Based Perspectives on Risk Perception and Adaptation Strategies." Md. Tanvir Ahmed, Md. Al Amin (2023). *Perilous Resurgence of Dengue Fever in Bangladesh: Gender Based Perspectives on Risk Perception and Adaptation Strategies*. *Universal Journal of Public Health* 11, no. 5 (2024): 751-760.

Under Review

1. "The Impact of Energy Efficiency and Conservation Master Plan on Primary Energy Consumption in Bangladesh: A Synthetic Control Analysis," *Energy Policy*

Working Papers (Dissertation Chapters)

1. "WIC Redemptions, Household Food Security, and the Quality of Food Acquisitions," with Travis A. Smith
2. "How Would Changes to Community Eligibility Provision Thresholds Affect Child Diet Quality?" with Travis A. Smith
3. "Measuring the Distance to Food Sufficiency: A Continuous Approach to Food Hardship," with Travis A. Smith

Research Presentations

1. "WIC Redemptions, Household Food Security, and the Quality of Food Acquisition," AAEA & WAEA Annual Meeting, July 2025.
2. "An Economic Assessment of the Hog Plum Production as an Alternative to Other Agricultural Crops at Jhalokathi District in Bangladesh." Jahangirnagar University, December 2021.
3. "The Economic Analysis on Hog Plum Production at Jhalokathi District in Bangladesh." University of Barishal, March 2019.

Conference Papers (Accepted)

1. "Measuring the Distance to Food Sufficiency: A Continuous Approach to Food Hardship," Southern Economic Association, November 2026.
2. "How Would Changes to Community Eligibility Provision Thresholds Affect Child Diet Quality?" Agricultural and Applied Economic Association, July 2026.
3. "Assessing the Effectiveness of the Bangladesh Climate Change Strategy and Action Plan (BCCSAP) on Food Security: A Difference-in-Differences Approach." Southern Economic Association, November 2024.

Grants, Honors, and Awards

- **Travel Grant Award**, Agricultural and Applied Economics Association (AAEA) Annual Meeting 2026
 - Competitively selected to present research at a leading international conference, recognizing the significance and policy relevance of the work
- **Travel Grant Award**, Agricultural and Applied Economics Association (AAEA) Annual Meeting 2025
 - Awarded competitive funding based on research quality and contribution to applied economic and policy analysis
- **Faculty Dean Award**, University of Barishal, Bangladesh 2022
 - Awarded competitively in recognition of outstanding academic performance and distinction among top-performing students
- **B.S.S Merit Scholarship**, Porijon Inc., Sylhet, Bangladesh 2015–2018
 - Merit-based scholarship awarded through competitive selection based on sustained academic excellence

Work Experience

- **Graduate Research Assistant**, University of Georgia 05/2025 – Present
 - Working under the supervision of Dr. Travis A. Smith on the project titled “*The Effects of Medicaid, SNAP, and Dual Enrollment on Food Insecurity*” (Proposal ID: 122608).
 - Assisting in data extraction, cleaning, and merging of Food Security Supplement (FSS) and Annual Social and Economic Supplement (ASES) datasets from the Current Population Survey (CPS).
 - Constructing instrumental variables (IVs) for Medicaid and SNAP eligibility using state-level policy variations from ERS-USDA, KFF, and the Urban Institute.
 - Applying advanced econometric methods (Borusyak and Hull, 2021; 2023) for recentered IV estimation to address endogeneity concerns.
 - Conducting heterogeneity analyses by race, ethnicity, and geographic region to identify disparities in program impacts.
- **Teaching Assistant**, University of Georgia 01/2025 – 05/2025
 - Assisted in the undergraduate course *AAEC 3600: Economics of Food Policy*, taught by Dr. Travis A. Smith.
 - Conducted weekly TA sessions every Friday to review lecture materials and help students with problem sets.
 - Graded assignments and exams, and provided feedback to improve student understanding of food policy economics.
- **Teaching Assistant**, University of Georgia 08/2024 – 12/2024
 - Assisted Dr. Genti Kostandini in teaching *AAEC 3690: Agribusiness Finance*.
 - Held weekly lab sessions and office hours to support students with problem-solving and Microsoft Excel-based financial analysis.
 - Helped design, grade, and provide feedback on homework, lab assignments, and exams.
 - Guided students on topics including time value of money, financial statement analysis, capital budgeting, and risk-return assessment.
- **Graduate Research Assistant**, University of Georgia 06/2024 – 08/2024
 - Collaborated with Professor Greg Colson on a sensitive project compiling faculty data, publications, titles, and publicly available salaries across multiple universities.
 - Collected, verified, and updated faculty information using departmental websites, CVs, and publication records, ensuring data accuracy and completeness for reports to the CAES Deans, UGA Provost, and UGA President.
 - Maintained data integrity by following strict confidentiality protocols and careful documentation of changes.
 - Focused on metrics such as PhD year, journal publications in AJAE, JEEM, and JAERE, and faculty titles, while preparing data for subsequent salary analysis.
- **Graduate Research Assistant**, University of Georgia 08/2023 – 05/2024
 - Assisted Dr. Yukiko Hashida and Dr. Suhyun Jung on the project “*Conservation Reserve Program that Changes Farmers’ Labor Allocation, Land Use/Cover, and Local Welfare in the U.S.*”.
 - Conducted data management and analysis combining USDA CRP data, Census of Agriculture, and American Community Survey datasets to study changes in land use/cover, labor allocation, and local welfare.
 - Generated descriptive statistics to understand CRP enrollment trends and evaluated causal mechanisms underlying program impacts on farmers and local communities.
 - Supported literature review and empirical modeling, focusing on behavioral responses, resource allocation, and economic outcomes at the farm and community levels.
- **Teaching Assistant**, Ohio University 08/2022 – 12/2022
 - Assisted Dr. Cortney Rodet in teaching the undergraduate course *Introductory Statistics (MATH 1500)*.

- Held recitation sessions, supported students in understanding statistical concepts, and addressed questions during office hours.
- Graded assignments, exams, and provided constructive feedback to enhance student learning outcomes.
- **Graduate Assistant, Ohio University** 01/2023 – 05/2023
 - **Teaching Assistant – Introductory Statistics (MATH 1500, Online):** Supported Dr. Cortney Rodet by conducting virtual recitations and providing one-on-one guidance, resulting in improved student engagement and understanding of statistical concepts; graded assignments and exams accurately to maintain timely course feedback.
 - **Course Support – Intermediate Microeconomics:** Collaborated with Dr. Daniel Karney to prepare lecture materials and supplemental content, streamlining course delivery and enhancing learning resources for over 120 undergraduate students.
 - **Research Assistance – Economics Projects:** Assisted Dr. Roberto Duncan in literature review, data collection, and preliminary analysis, contributing to actionable insights and supporting progress on multiple research studies.
- **Lecturer – Principles of Microeconomics, Right Academy, Bangladesh** 01/2021 – 07/2022
 - Taught undergraduate-level Principles of Microeconomics and Macroeconomics.
 - Prepared weekly examinations, invigilated tests, and graded class tests and examinations.
- **Lecturer – Mathematics, Saifur's Private Limited, Bangladesh** 01/2019 – 12/2020
 - Taught undergraduate mathematics using problem-solving and application-based instruction.
 - Developed class assessments and monthly examinations, and evaluated student performance.
- **Undergraduate Tutor, Bangladesh** 2019 – 2022
 - Tutored 23 undergraduate students in Principles of Microeconomics, Mathematics, and Statistics.
 - Provided individualized academic support to strengthen students' analytical and quantitative skills.

Volunteering Experience

- **Class Representative (CR), Department of Economics, University of Barishal, Bangladesh** 2015–2019
 - Served as a liaison between students and faculty, ensuring student concerns were heard and addressed.
 - Coordinated academic feedback, represented student interests in departmental meetings, and organized study groups and peer mentoring sessions.
 - Strengthened communication between students and faculty, contributing to a more supportive academic environment and higher student satisfaction.
- **Executive Member – Academic and Career Discipline, Networks of Economics Students of Barishal University (NESBU)** 2018
 - Supported academic and career development programs for economics students.
 - Organized workshops, seminars, and networking events with professionals and alumni, managing communication and logistics for events.
 - Improved student access to career guidance and professional opportunities, enhancing engagement in NESBU initiatives.

References

Travis A. Smith

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